

Through this RFP KHDA invites responses from vendors to propose a contractual arrangement that meets the requirements described in this document. The vendor responses should address all the requirements stated in this document.

This RFP is not an **offer** by KHDA, but an invitation for vendor response. **No** contractual obligation whatsoever shall arise from this RFP process, unless and until a formal contract is **signed** and executed by duly authorized officers of KHDA and the Vendor.

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1. Introduction and background

Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) is a government entity established in Dubai with a vital mission: to drive the continuous development of the emirate's education sector. Our focus lies on improving the quality and outcomes of education at all levels, ensuring a thriving educational landscape that aligns with Dubai's dynamic economic and social growth.

The Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) is seeking a qualified and experienced vendor to select a Kentico partner who will build for us a responsive, secure, and SEO optimized website on the Kentico platform.

Learn More About Us: For a deeper understanding of our mission and initiatives, please visit our website: <http://www.khda.gov.ae>

2. Project Overview

Purpose of this RFP:

- The intent of this RFP is to select a Kentico partner who will build for us a responsive, secure, and SEO optimized website on the Kentico platform.
- With advances in technology and increased expectations of data, analysis, and information from ourselves, our stakeholders and investors, it is evident that our current practices and services need revitalization and improved digitization. Our intention is to start with our website, which will serve as our gateway to a unified service offering to serve our community.

Current Situation

- Although the current KHDA website, www.khda.gov.ae, is high scoring on the happiness meter and other government audits, it can be further improved to support the customer centric approach of KHDA and meet our strategic aspirations.

Project Goals

- **Usable, accessible and aesthetically pleasing website (a website full of empathy)** - a website that is easy to use by all, regardless of their ability, and takes into consideration all the government requirements.
- **Intuitive** - a website that can respond to the needs of the user in the following way:
 - **Responsive:** regardless of the device, internet connection, browser or location of the user. The user will be able to experience the website as it was intended to be experienced
 - **User journeys:** can easily predict the user needs and provide appropriate flows to pertinent information based on type of user
 - **Personalisation:** providing interactive service, catalogues and service cards along with cookies to personalise the experience.
 - **Usable:** the user can easily share, and/or export data and information in different formats that can be used for different purposes
 - **Fast-load times:** the user experience is fast and efficient.
- **Integration with existing systems** – should integrate easily with all KHDA existing system or forms a user-friendly layer on top of them.

- **Scalable** – can easily grow to accommodate any future needs.
- **SEO Optimization** – implementation of best practices to enhance search engine ranking.

3. Scope of Work

KENTICO PARTNER DELIVERABLES:

Project timelines				
#	Deliverable	Description	Expected Format/Output	Target Completion date
1	New KHDA Website using the latest version of Kentico version	Website as per KHDA's Digital Experience & Service Transformation teams' vision and design of the website on the Kentico platform.	Website & Application	26 th May 2025

Exclusions

- Partner to provide any terms and conditions pertaining to their offer as an attachment to their proposal. Exceptions to requirements must be clearly identified.
- Kentico Subscription, Licenses and Infrastructure will be provided by KHDA

Project Team Staffing

1. Partner to state all roles applicable for this project and the number of personnel required for each. Possible roles include Kentico Architect, Administrator, UI/UX Designer, Developer, QA, Content Manager, SEO Specialist, Web Security Specialist, DevSecOps Engineer.
2. Confirmation letter that these are the Partner's full-time employees.
Substitution of Project Team Members: During the assignment, the substitution of key staff identified for the assignment will not be allowed unless concurred by KHDA. The Partner will provide other staff of same level of qualifications and expertise. If unsatisfied with the replacement, KHDA reserves the right to terminate the contract and recover whatever payments made by KHDA to the Partner during the course of this assignment besides claiming an amount, equal to the contract value as liquidated damages. However, KHDA reserves the right to insist on replacing any team member with another during the

course of assignment for valid reasons. The Partner cannot change the Project Manager during the entire period of execution of the assignment unless concurred in writing by KHDA.

Project Methodology and Schedule

The partner should describe the implementation approach, project management tools, methodologies and schedule for the proposed solution that the Partner will follow upon award of the contract. The document should answer among other things how long the proposed solution implementation will take.

Information Security

Partner to state their approach to security in developing and maintaining websites on Kentico.

Risk Matrix

Delays/Risks to the project must be identified and appropriate mitigations shown.

Costs

- A detailed breakdown of the costs must be shown.
- All licensing costs if any, should be shown separately including maintenance term.
- Maintenance agreement costs must be shown separately.

Warranty Term

- Partner to state terms and conditions applicable for the warranty term.

Maintenance

- Partner to state terms and conditions applicable for the maintenance term.
- Partner to confirm usage of Jira provided by KHDA to log all support tickets.

4. Deliverables

1	The Kentico partner is expected to collaborate with KHDA's Digital Experience & Service Transformation teams to implement the vision and design of the website on the Kentico platform. The KHDA Digital Experience & Service Transformation teams will provide the Wire frames, UI Design, Service Blueprint, Service Catalogue, Journey map for the website. The website is expected to be in English and Arabic with API, Analytics, and Social Media integrations.	Digital Experience team will validate and approve all deliverables	Digital delivery
2	Accessibility is vital to our website, and we are aiming to comply with the highest level of the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 – specifically, the AAA criteria. Hence the Kentico partner must have sufficient experience to implement a AAA compliant version of the Website that will be accessible from the main Website as a separate version.		
3	The Kentico partner is expected to provide and implement the best practices to ensure that the Kentico platform is utilized to its full potential in line with expectations.		
4	The Kentico partner will provide its initial quote based on KHDA's current website. Short-listed partners will be provided an overview of a redesigned scope to fine-tune their proposals should they wish to.		
5	The Kentico partner is expected to provide a one-month warranty for the works that are scoped and implemented by the said partner.		
6	The Kentico partner is expected to provide a brief audit report of our existing website and how the Partner can change it to better serve our customers		
7	The Kentico partner will provide a separate maintenance scope and cost for 500 hours with lock-in price for one year that will include maintaining and upgrading the Kentico platform, implementing changes, bug-fixing, security fixes and updates, etc. for a period of one year from the warranty end date.		

5. Evaluation criteria

- KHDA will evaluate proposals based on the following criteria:
- **Criteria 1:** Company portfolio with similar projects
 - Innovation and creativity
 - User centeredness
 - Language
 - Accessibility options
 - Dubai & UAE Government clients
- **Criteria 2:** Proven track record of successful project completion in similar contexts
- **Criteria 4:** Methodology and approach to project execution
- **Criteria 5:** Ability to meet project timelines.
- **Criteria 3:** Qualifications and experience of the proposed project team
- **Criteria 6:** Competitiveness of pricing cost and structure
- **Criteria 7:** Payment and credit terms
- **Criteria 8:** Audit report of current Website
- **Criteria 9:** Technical criteria will include approach towards content management, usage analytics, security architecture and overall technology stack
- **Criteria 9:** Budget and delivery timeframe

6. Submission instructions

Eligibility requirements KHDA welcome bids from all qualified vendors who meet the following criteria:

- UAE National or GCC National: companies or individuals who are citizens of the United Arab Emirates or a member state of the Gulf Cooperation Council.
- Free zone company: companies licensed and operating within a free zone in the Emirate of Dubai or any other Emirate of the UAE.
- Foreign company: foreign companies or corporations operating outside of the UAE, subject to meeting all relevant rules and regulations.
- Is not an employee of KHDA, whether he participates in the capacity of owner or partner.
- Meets the financial, technical, and professional requirements stipulated in the terms of the Contract; and meet any other conditions determined by KHDA.

Proposal requirements

- Company profile.
- The tender proposals. Proposals should separate commercial and technical parts of the response.
- Other requested documents specified within the project requirements.
- A Tender Bond (**Bid Bond**) for an amount of **2%** of the total tendered price must be issued to the order of KHDA and must be attached to the tender documents.
- The Bid Bond must be valid as from the Bid submission date and for at least sixty (60) days after expiry of the Bid validity.
- Bids submitted without Bid Bond will not be considered during the evaluation process.
- A duly authorized representative (Signatory) of the vendor shall sign the original copy of the proposal.

Submission documents:

Eligibility documents:

The submission shall include the following documents to ensure bidders meet eligibility tender criteria:

- License from the concerned authority.
- Owner's Passport copy
- Evidence not to be deprived from taking part in any of the tenders and bids held by any of the authorities.
- Not to be one of the employees in the authority party to the contract and may not be first class relative to any of the officials concerned with contracting.
- To achieve all the financial, technical, and professional terms and conditions stated in the Contract.

Compliance Requirements:

- All bidders must comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and directives of the United Arab Emirates (UAE), including but not limited to:
 - Law No. (12) of 2020 concerning Contracts and Warehouse Management in the Government of Dubai.
- Bidders delivering products or services with environmental impact are required to submit a Green Purchasing Policy outlining their commitment to sustainable practices. The specific requirements will be based on the nature of the project deliverables.
- Depending on the project nature and deliverables, bidders may be required to demonstrate compliance with specific Dubai Electronic Security Center (DESC) policies and certifications. Please refer to the project description for details.

Proposal documents:

RFP Preparation:

The proposal needs to address the distinct phases of the project with the estimated costs for each item mentioned as above. The recommendation is to carry out the implementation as per the Project Timeline indicated to ensure that proper focus is maintained for the various activities and business processes; indicate the proposed methodology & details of the major activities and the respective costs. The selected vendor will be required to be involved from start to finish of the implementation of the scope of item selected and ensure that the KHDA project team is aware with the procedures to handle future efforts independently.

Interested companies should submit the following documents electronically by (3rd Feb 2025):

- A cover letter outlining your experience and qualifications for this project, and a company profile.
- A brief that demonstrates your understanding of KHDA's goals and objectives for this project.
- A proposed project timeline that outlines key milestones and deliverables.
- A detailed cost proposal that breaks down all project costs.
- Submit client references.

7. Tentative timelines

This is a tentative schedule and may be subject to change.

Timelines	Key Dates:
RFP release date	07 Feb 2025
Deadline for submitting question and requesting for meetings (by vendor)	12 Feb 2025
Response to questions (by KHDA)	14 Feb 2025
Proposal submission deadline	24 Feb 2025
Proposal review period (by KHDA)	27 Feb 2025
Evaluation of proposal (by KHDA)	13 March 2025
Selection and awarding decision	17 March 2025

8. Contact information

For any questions or clarifications regarding this RFP, please contact (Project Manager, Saad Farukh) at (saad.farukh@khda.gov.ae) for technical requirements and for procurement related inquiries please contact (Head of Procurement, Aisha Al Hashemi) at (aisha.alhashemi@khda.gov.ae).

9. Additional information

- Confidentiality:
 - All information contained in this RFP and any other additional information received during the RFP process, is confidential and proprietary to KHDA.
 - Disclosure or use of any information contained in this RFP by any means, in whole or in part, for any reason other than for the purpose of responding to the RFP, is strictly prohibited.
 - KHDA is neither required nor obliged, to discuss or explain the reasons for the acceptance or rejection of any Bidder's response.
- KHDA reserves the right to shortlist vendors for presentations or request clarifications on proposals.
- This RFP does not constitute a commitment by KHDA to award a contract.



- The successful vendor will be expected to collaborate effectively with KHDA throughout the project duration.

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